Nasma (نسمة)

Nasma sells handmade soy scented candles inspired by Alexandria's neighborhoods (Bahary, Sidi Gaber, El-Manshiya) — 180 EGP for a 220 g candle with a claimed 35-40 hour burn, sold on Instagram and WhatsApp with cash on delivery. · 2026-11-11

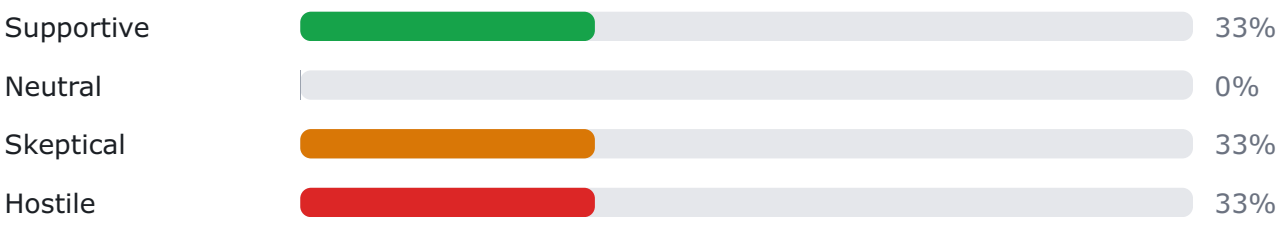
Research-backed report: 5 sources were opened and read on 2026-11-11. Every market or competitor number points to a source id such as [s1]. Anything without a source is marked "inferred" or "assumption".

This report comes from a simulation, not a measurement of the real market. The objections below are hypotheses to check cheaply yourself before any decision.

Assumptions made:

- Unattended run on a fictional product: the owner was not available for questions, so every gap was recorded here instead of being silently guessed.
- The burn time (35-40 hours) is the owner's claim from the brief — not a documented burn test; the personas treat it as a claim.
- Production cost and margin are unknown (wax, wicks, fragrance, jars) — the report makes no judgement on pricing viability.
- Scent throw and room coverage are not in the brief — treated as an experience gap, not a fact.
- The 100% soy claim has no test or certificate behind it — the brief says soy wax with no paperwork.
- Whether the packaging survives summer shipping (soy wax in a delivery van) is unknown — the brief mentions no thermal protection.
- Each persona's monthly income is an assumption (not in the brief); the 150-400 EGP gift budget is real, from the brief.
- The announcement post was built only from the brief's facts (price, sizes, delivery, COD) with no invented offer — because this was an unattended run and no real post was handed over.
- Test sales are near zero per the brief — treated as reality: zero documented reviews are available to the brand.

Sentiment split



Objections, ranked

1. A brand new with zero reviews — 180 EGP prepaid is a bet, not a purchase

Blocker | Trust | Fix by messaging | 4 mentions [s3, s4]

Suggested fix: Before any marketing spend: turn the first 10-20 buyers (even neighbors and colleagues) into documented reviews with a short video and a photo of the delivered product — literally what the feed asked for ('6 reviews are the proof'). Handmade brands prove themselves with faces and photos, not sentences.

Quick check you can run yourself: The last new brand you bought from on Instagram — what was the first thing that made you trust it?

2. The burn time (35-40 hours) is an unverified claim — and the whole pitch rests on it

Blocker | Trust | Fix by design | 3 mentions [s2]

Suggested fix: Burn one candle on camera as a timelapse and publish the real number on the post. One documented number wins the entire EGP/hour argument (4.5-5.1 against IKEA's 5.5) — and from there the post starts winning.

Quick check you can run yourself: If a brand tells you the candle burns for 40 hours, do you trust the printed number or want to see it yourself?

3. The skeptic's math: 180 = 3 souq candles (20-60 EGP) — a 3x to 9x gap on his usual shelf

Blocker | Price | Fix by messaging | 2 mentions [s5, s2]

Suggested fix: Do not argue about the price — replace the math: 'a souq candle fades in 10-15 hours with no number; we publish our number per hour', and tie it to the documented test from o2. With the budget skeptic you win the calculation, not the sentence.

Quick check you can run yourself: When did you last buy a candle, for how much — and how long did it actually burn?

4. Cairo delivery at 45 EGP = 25% of the price — and a soy candle arriving in summer?

Friction | Convenience | Fix by design | 2 mentions [s5]

Suggested fix: Test Cairo shipping yourself before offering it: send a candle to a Cairo address in peak heat (July-August) and inspect the state on arrival. If it needs thermal insulation (bubble wrap + a wax-safe box), price it in and say it explicitly in the post.

Quick check you can run yourself: The last order that arrived warped or damaged by shipping — what did you do? Did you use the same service again?

5. The gift buyer's risk: no testing before sending, no exchange policy

Friction | Convenience | Fix by design | 2 mentions

Suggested fix: One written policy: 'Did not like the scent? A one-time exchange for another scent.' It costs a candle, and it buys the gifter's whole decision instead of pushing them to a pricier brand they already trust.

Quick check you can run yourself: If you gifted a candle and your friend hated the scent — what would you want to happen?

6. Scent throw is unknown: does 'Bahary' actually smell of the sea? And how much room does it cover?

Friction | Trust | Fix by design | 2 mentions

Suggested fix: Small trial samples (40-50 g of wax) of the three scents at 60-80 EGP with delivery inside Alexandria, or a trial bundle for the undecided. And publish a profile per scent (Bahary: who it suits) — the persona invented it in the feed.

Quick check you can run yourself: Think of the last candle you used: was its scent strong enough for your room, or did it fade within half an hour?

7. The gift wrap (+30) has no real photos — and it is the deciding point for the gift buyer

Friction | Trust | Fix by messaging | 2 mentions [s1]

Suggested fix: Publish 3-4 real photos of the wrap from every angle (kraft, the handwritten card, how it opens) in the post's archive. One real photo takes under an hour and decides a 210 EGP gift.

Quick check you can run yourself: When you look at a brand's gift-wrap photos, what makes a real photo beat a design?

Unspoken objections (hypotheses)

'Soy' is a claim with no paperwork — and if it turns out to be a paraffin blend, the brand burns down once

Why it may exist: The 100% soy claim is common in the category (Tablowhaty says the same, s4) and no published test exists for any local brand. The skeptic raised it as a spark ('a grocery word') but never took it to its conclusion — one rumor in a WhatsApp group can kill a small brand completely.

Quick check you can run yourself: If a candle brand claimed '100% soy' and it turned out to be a blend — would you blame the brand or the whole market?

Handmade is not a feature in the audience's eyes — it is inconsistent quality

Why it may exist: The skeptic said it verbatim ('candle number 30 was made after number 29') — handmade means batch-to-batch variation, and the audience will not say it to the owner because it is an emotional point, not a technical one. First-batch defects (an off wick, a weaker scent) will arrive as individual complaints, not a public objection.

Quick check you can run yourself: If you bought a candle, loved it, and the second one had a weaker scent — how would you feel about the brand?

There is no summer plan: candles get bought in summer without anyone asking about shipping

Why it may exist: Not in the brief, and the research found no thermal-packaging signal in the local market. It stays unspoken because buyers only learn it from experience (a warped candle arrives) — and a persona already raised it ('soy melts') without a fix.

Quick check you can run yourself: Do you buy candles in summer? If your order arrives warped — do you blame the seller or the courier?

What attracted people

- The Alexandria-neighborhood scent idea is a differentiation we found nobody else doing — Aromatica sells a scent; Nasma sells a district
- A full gift at 210 EGP with the wrap sits inside the ready 150-400 budget — half the cheapest documented handmade brand (about 450)
- Cost per burn hour favors Nasma (4.5-5.1) over documented factory mass (IKEA's 40-hour cup = 5.5)
- Gift wrap at 30 EGP undercuts Aromatica's 50 — and adds one more sensory step to the brand

Next steps to validate

- Burn one candle on camera as a timelapse and publish the real burn hours — it kills the biggest blocker (o2) with a phone camera and one burn.
- Take 3-4 real photos of the gift wrap from every angle and pin them in the Instagram archive — one hour of work that decides a gift (o7).
- Trial samples: 40-50 g of wax in each of the three scents at 60-80 EGP with Alexandria delivery — opens the door for the undecided (o6).
- Write a one-time scent-exchange policy for gifts and put it in the bio — the cost is one candle, the gain is full trust (o5).

- Test Cairo shipping yourself in peak heat: send a candle to a Cairo address in July-August and inspect it on arrival before committing to the service (o4).

Market study

Egypt's scented-candle market splits into three tiers: handmade premium (Aromatica — handmade in Cairo, 320-1250 EGP, shipping from 80 EGP, gift wrap 50 EGP), global mass (IKEA Egypt, 75 products from 49 to 449 EGP with strong seasonal discounts), and a quiet artisan tier (Creative Egypt lists a 410 EGP soy candle that is out of stock with zero reviews; noon Egypt carries a 400 g 100% soy candle by Tablowhaty, also out of stock with no listed price). Below all of it sit souq candles at 20-60 EGP per the owner's estimate. So there is a clear premium ceiling and a clear cheap floor, and the middle between them is exactly where Nasma sits — but that middle is also nearly empty of social proof: the research found no published reviews for any local artisan brand.

Signals from sources

Signal	Source
Aromatica sells handmade candles made in Cairo for 320-1250 EGP before shipping (prices dated 8 October 2026), with shipping from 80 EGP and gift wrap at 50 EGP	[s1]
IKEA Egypt lists 75 scented candles: a 12-hour cup at 49-59, a 20-hour cup at 109 (and a 169 to 59 promo), a 40-hour cup at 219, and a 3-wick 25-hour at 449	[s2]
An artisan soy scented candle listed at 410 EGP on Creative Egypt — out of stock, with zero reviews	[s3]
A 100% soy candle by Tablowhaty (400 g) listed on noon Egypt via kanbkam — out of stock, price not listed	[s4]
The owner estimates souq candles at 20-60 EGP — the reference the budget skeptic measures against (to be confirmed with a quick check)	[s5]

Price benchmarks

Item	Price	Unit	Source
Nasma — 220 g soy candle	180 EGP	per candle (claimed 35-40 h burn means 4.5-5.1 EGP/hour)	[s5]

Nasma — 3-candle bundle	480 EGP	per bundle (160 per candle — 20 EGP saved each)	[s5]
Nasma — gift wrap (kraft + handwritten card)	+30 EGP	per order	[s5]
Aromatica — teddy candle, 161 g	320 EGP	per piece (about 2.0 EGP/g)	[s1]
Aromatica — 350 g jar	550 EGP	per piece (about 1.57 EGP/g)	[s1]
Aromatica — gift wrap	50 EGP	per order	[s1]
IKEA — 40-hour cup	219 EGP	per piece (about 5.5 EGP per burn hour)	[s2]
IKEA — 20-hour vanilla cup (JÄMLIK)	169 to 59 EGP	per piece (about 3.0 EGP/hour at the promo price)	[s2]
Creative Egypt — soy scented candle	410 EGP	per piece (out of stock)	[s3]
Souq candles	20-60 EGP	per piece (owner's estimate — burn hours unknown)	[s5]

What this means for the product (analysis, not a source)

- Analysis: cost per burn hour favors Nasma — 180 EGP over a claimed 35-40 hours means 4.5-5.1 EGP/hour, cheaper than IKEA's 40-hour cup (219 = 5.5 EGP/h) and far below

handmade premium (Aromatica's 350 g jar at 550). But the math only holds if the burn-time number is true — and that is a new brand's claim, not a published test.

- Analysis: the budget skeptic does not see 'EGP/hour' first — he sees '180 = 3 souq candles (20-60 EGP)', a 3x to 9x gap on the same shelf. The brand has to run the correct math in public (a timed burn video) before the audience runs the wrong one.
- Analysis: for gifts, a Nasma candle with wrap = 210 EGP versus the cheapest Aromatica gift = 320 + 50 wrap + 80 shipping, about 450. A strong deal for the gifter — missing only proof that the recipient will feel the value (brand plus the wrap experience).
- Analysis: Cairo shipping at 45 EGP = 25% of the candle's price. Soy wax melts at fairly low heat (a known property of the material, assumed here) — summer shipping without documented thermal packaging can arrive warped, and that risk sits on 25% of the invoice.

Competitors and substitutes

Aromatica **Direct competitor** [s1]

Offer: Handmade scented candles made in Cairo, a wide range (teddy candles, mini sets, jars, 3-wick, outdoor) with ready gift wrap and personalization (names, dates, cards) — exactly Nasma's category, only better known.

Prices: 320-1250 EGP before shipping; teddy 161 g at 320; 350 g jar at 550; shipping from 80; gift wrap 50 [s1]

Strengths: A known brand with a ready-made gift range · Personalization (names and cards) is real gift value · Declared delivery coverage inside Egypt

Weaknesses: The cheapest piece is 320 — it blows through a single-gift budget fast · 80 EGP shipping stacks onto small orders

Customer voice: No data found

IKEA Egypt **Direct competitor** [s2]

Offer: Global mass scented candles in glass cups — the same use (ambiance and light) with no local identity, at factory prices.

Prices: 49-449 EGP; the 40-hour cup at 219; the 20-hour cup at 109 (and a 169 to 59 promo) [s2]

Strengths: Always in stock at scale · Seasonal discounts up to 60% · Burn hours printed by the factory

Weaknesses: Generic scents with no story or identity · The same experience in every home

Customer voice: No data found

Creative Egypt (soy candle) Indirect competitor [s3]

Offer: An Egyptian artisan marketplace listing a soy scented candle — a category rival (artisan soy), not a brand rival: the product is out of stock with no activity around it.

Prices: 410 EGP per piece — out of stock, zero reviews [s3]

Strengths: An artisan marketplace with display credibility · Soy wax, the same category as Nasma

Weaknesses: Out of stock — not an active rival on the shelf · Zero reviews: even this category has no social proof

Customer voice: No data found

Tablowhaty on noon Egypt Indirect competitor [s4]

Offer: A 100% soy candle brand listed on the biggest marketplace — proof that the category is moving beyond Instagram, though it is still fragile.

Prices: 400 g — price not listed, out of stock [s4]

Strengths: Reach through a marketplace with stronger trust channels · A bigger size (400 g) · A public 100% soy claim on a platform, not on Instagram

Weaknesses: Out of stock · Price not listed — no reference point

Customer voice: No data found

Souq and kiosk candles Substitute [s5]

Offer: Cheap scented candles from the souq people already buy from daily — the substitute the budget skeptic keeps in mind against any brand price.

Prices: 20-60 EGP per piece (owner's estimate — unknown burn hours, generic scents) [s5]

Strengths: Far cheaper · Available instantly in any street · No shipping and no waiting

Weaknesses: No burn-hour or material information · Generic, repeated scents · No story or gift around it

Customer voice: No data found

Personas: full profile and a full day

Maryam Abdelal @maryam_gifts · Supportive

The gift buyer (25-32): A 28-year-old marketing employee in Smouha. Every month there is an engagement, a birthday or a friend's occasion. She likes gifts with a story, and she cares how the gift lands in front of people.

Age: 28 **Occupation:** Marketing employee **Location:** Smouha, Alexandria

Budget: 150-400 EGP per gift (from the brief); personal income estimated at 10,000-14,000 EGP/month (assumption)

Current alternatives: Aromatica · Souq and kiosk candles

Pain points: 'Gifts with a story' in Alexandria end on the same lists (flowers, perfumes, decor) · The nice handmade brands cross 350 EGP and eat the whole gift budget · She is the one held accountable if the gift misses with the recipient

Buying triggers: A gift that tells a story: a scent named after an Alexandria neighborhood is a ready story · Gift wrap at 30 EGP instead of a brand's 50 · A review from someone she knows before buying from a new brand

Facts from sources:

- The cheapest Aromatica gift piece is 320 EGP + 50 wrap + 80 shipping — a handmade-brand gift effectively starts at about 450 EGP [s1]
- Her gift budget of 150-400 EGP per gift is from the brief — Nasma with wrap (210) fits inside it easily [s5]

A full day, waking to sleep

Evidence behind this day: Sourced 1 · Inferred 2 · Assumption 9

Time	Activity	Evidence
07:00	Wakes up, coffee, first phone check	Assumption
07:40	Scrolls Instagram before work → Nasma's post appears in the feed — 'scents of Alexandria's neighborhoods' is a line that stops her	Assumption
08:30	Microbus to work	Assumption
09:00	Marketing job, meetings and content	Assumption
12:30	Break: the 'college girls' WhatsApp group asks about an engagement gift → Gifts get decided in these groups — if Nasma's post is forwarded here, that is the real distribution	Inferred
16:00	Back home	Assumption
17:00	Opens Aromatica's site to look for her friend's gift → The cheapest piece is 320 + 50 wrap + 80 shipping = about 450 — above a single-gift budget	Sourced [s1]
18:30	Compares: returns to Nasma's post and adds 180 + 30 wrap + 25 delivery = 235 → Half the cheapest handmade gift — but she asks herself: will it arrive looking like the photos?	Inferred [s5]
19:30	Dinner with family	Assumption
21:00	Second Instagram scroll → She looks for Nasma reviews in tagged posts — nothing there	Assumption
22:15	Forwards Nasma's post to her friend for a second opinion	Assumption
23:30	Sleep	Assumption

Karim Sarhan @karim_at_desk · Skeptical

The WFH atmosphere lover: A 31-year-old remote graphic designer in Ibrahimiya. He sits at a desk 9-10 hours a day. He wants a calm environment and a steady scent while working, and buys a candle for himself every month or two.

Age: 31 **Occupation:** Remote graphic designer **Location:** Ibrahimiya, Alexandria

Budget: Estimated 14,000-18,000 EGP/month (assumption); candle budget 150-250 EGP every two months (assumption)

Current alternatives: IKEA Egypt · Souq and kiosk candles

Pain points: Mass-market scents fade fast over his long sessions — he keeps a candle burning a full day · He buys every two months, meaning he re-decides ten times a year — he needs a reason that persists · He will not pay a new brand without a burn number he can trust

Buying triggers: A documented burn number (a video or a test, not a label) · A scent that survives 6-8 working hours, not one · A burn-hour reference from another brand to compare against

Facts from sources:

- IKEA's 40-hour cup at 219 EGP = 5.5 EGP/hour — his factory-made reference for the math [s2]
- IKEA's 20-hour promo at 59 EGP (59% off) keeps the category open at a small budget at any time [s2]
- He browses IKEA's site himself on an ordinary day [s2]

A full day, waking to sleep

Evidence behind this day: Sourced 1 · Inferred 1 · Assumption 8

Time	Activity	Evidence
08:00	Wakes up in the flat, coffee at the desk before opening the laptop	Assumption
09:00	Remote work from the home office → This desk is the candle's real use case — 9 working hours means a scent that must last	Assumption
11:00	Break: opens IKEA's site looking for a desk lamp → He stumbles into the candle category: the 20-hour cup at 109 and the 40-hour cup at 219 — factory numbers, printed	Sourced [s2]
13:00	Quick lunch	Assumption
17:00	Coffee on the balcony	Assumption
19:00	Evening work block (a client deadline)	Assumption
21:30	A film or a sitcom	Assumption
22:30	Scrolls X and sees Nasma's launch post → First contact with the brand — the 180 EGP price hits him immediately	Assumption

23:00	Runs the math: 180 over 35-40 hours = 4.5-5.1 EGP/hour against IKEA's 5.5 → The math favors Nasma — but he asks: who said 40 hours?	Inferred [s5, s2]
00:30	Sleep	Assumption

Hassan El-Far @hassan_el7asb · Hostile

The budget skeptic (divides the price by burn hours): A 43-year-old accountant in Fleming, attached to wholesale math in every purchase. He buys souq candles at 20-60 EGP and is convinced that any price above that is 'inflation spirit'.

Age: 43 **Occupation:** Accountant **Location:** Fleming, Alexandria

Budget: Estimated 300-500 EGP/month household treats budget (assumption)

Current alternatives: Souq and kiosk candles

Pain points: Sees any new brand's price as 'broken math' until proven otherwise · His souq candles fade fast, but he never accounts for it because the price is small · Distrusts the 'soy' claim — there is no paperwork

Buying triggers: Burn hours computed from a verifiable source · A cheap trial sample before committing 180 EGP · A tangible difference in the experience, not in the sentence

Facts from sources:

- He buys souq candles at 20-60 EGP — 180 EGP means 3-9 candles from his usual shelf [s5]
- The cheapest documented per-hour reference: IKEA's 12-hour cup at 49-59 EGP, about 4-5 EGP/hour — close to Nasma's claim [s2]

A full day, waking to sleep

Evidence behind this day: Sourced 0 · Inferred 1 · Assumption 9

Time	Activity	Evidence
06:30	Wakes early, dawn prayer, coffee	Assumption
07:30	Tea and juice, radio or news	Assumption
08:30	To work — an accounting office	Assumption
13:00	Home for lunch with the family	Assumption
16:00	The neighborhood souq — buys from the kiosks → The candle shelf at the kiosk: 20-60 EGP — the reference he measures any brand price against	Inferred [s5]
17:30	Family sitting, television	Assumption
19:00	Dinner	Assumption

20:30	His son shows him Nasma's post on the phone → '180 EGP for a candle?!' — the first reaction	Assumption
21:00	Argues with his son about the math	Assumption
22:30	Sleep	Assumption

Simulated feed (evidence)

N **Nasma (نسمة)** @brand · #t1

Nasma 🕯️ Handmade soy candles with the scents of Alexandria's neighborhoods — Bahary, Sidi Gaber, El-Manshiya. 220 g of soy wax + a cotton wick, a 35-40 hour burn, and the glass jar stays with you. Price: 180 EGP | The three-scent bundle: 480 EGP | Gift wrap (kraft + a handwritten card): +30 EGP. Delivery: Alexandria 25 EGP — Cairo 45 EGP. Cash on delivery. Order on Instagram or WhatsApp — production is limited because we make everything by hand.

≡ 61 ↻ 9

H **Hassan El-Far** @hassan_el7asb · #t2

180 EGP for a candle?! I buy 3 candles from the kiosk for 90 and still have change. 'Soy wax' is a grocery word they print on a label and people pay for it. Put up one lab sheet proving it is actually soy and I'll open the conversation.

≡ 42 ↻ 6

M **Maryam Abdelal** @maryam_gifts · #t3

The scent idea is a ready-made gift in itself — 'Bahary' is the name of an Alexandria district; the recipient lives it instead of reading about it. I buy gifts every month and the cheapest handmade-brand gift starts above 450 with wrap and shipping. This one is 210 with the wrap. The number is very reasonable.

≡ 29 ↻ 4

K **Karim Sarhan** @karim_at_desk · #t4

Let me calculate instead of us getting emotional. 180 over 35-40 hours = 4.5-5.1 EGP per burn hour. IKEA's 40-hour cup = 219, that is 5.5 EGP/hour. So Nasma's price is cheaper per hour than the mass product itself. The only problem: who said 40 hours? The brand itself. No test, no video, no reference.

≡ 38 ↻ 7

H **Hassan El-Far** @hassan_el7asb · #t5

That is my point. Every label says nice numbers. The 60 EGP souq candle claims 30 hours too, and nobody ever audited it. The real math is not 'EGP/hour' — the real math is: when does it actually burn out, and will you see it with your own eyes.

≡ 31 ↻ 3

Karim Sarhan @karim_at_desk · #t6

Disagree. IKEA's number is factory-made with at least some QA. Nasma is a brand from zero — true. But the fix is not 'charge less'; the fix is publishing one documented test: a timelapse of a candle burning in front of a camera. One hour of content kills their biggest objection.

≡ 26 ↻ 5

Maryam Abdelal @maryam_gifts · #t7

Question for the brand: the 30 EGP wrap — what exactly is it? Kraft and a handwritten card is nice, but Aromatica charges 50 and the look is known. I am buying a gift, so the wrap is half the feeling. Show me a real photo of the wrap, not a design.

≡ 34 ↻ 6

Hassan El-Far @hassan_el7asb · #t8

And another thing: what does 'handmade' even mean in 2026? It means candle number 30 was made after number 29 and the batch varies. You are not buying a fixed product; you are buying a day in someone's life. That is not what these prices should be judged against.

≡ 27 ↻ 4

Maryam Abdelal @maryam_gifts · #t9

Exactly the opposite — that is the point. I am not buying a candle, I am buying a story to give: 'the scent of Sidi Gaber'. A factory candle never gives me a story.

≡ 22 ↻ 3

Karim Sarhan @karim_at_desk · #t10

A serious point: Cairo delivery is 45 EGP. This is a soy candle, and soy melts at fairly low heat. July shipping in a delivery van from Alexandria to Cairo — what exactly arrives? A half-melted jar? Not one word in the post about thermal packaging or a replacement policy.

≡ 41 ↻ 8

Hassan El-Far @hassan_el7asb · #t11

And that is 45 EGP on a 180 price = 25% shipping. In plain words: you are charging 180 and receiving 135 of candle value, while unsure it arrives intact.

≡ 24 ↻ 2

Maryam Abdelal @maryam_gifts · #t12

A gift also means I do not test before sending — I am the buyer, not the user. If my friend opens it and hates the scent, there is no exchange and no refund. I carry the blame for the failed gift in front of people. I need something that kills that fear.

≡ 33 ↻ 5

Karim Sarhan @karim_at_desk · #t13

That is a real gap, not noise. Suggestion: a 'one-time scent exchange' policy — the recipient swaps for another scent. It costs the brand one candle and buys far more trust.

≡ 28 ↻ 6

Karim Sarhan @karim_at_desk · #t14

Who said 'Bahary' actually smells like the sea? Scent is the most personal thing there is. I once bought a 'sea and sand' candle from another brand and it was plain vanilla. 180 EGP on a scent I am not sure about + 45 shipping = an expensive experiment. Where are the samples? A mini bundle of the three scents?

≡ 37 ↻ 7

Hassan El-Far @hassan_el7asb · #t15

That is one point, not three. A candle is not an equation; a candle is an unknown until it is lit. 600 followers and not a single review, and you want me to prepay 180?

≡ 29 ↻ 3

Maryam Abdelal @maryam_gifts · #t16

Update: after thinking it over — I will try it. The three-scent bundle at 480 is exactly what I will do: each friend gets a scent, and I am done running out of flowers-and-perfume ideas. But I want two things confirmed first: real photos of the wrap, and a review from someone who actually bought.

≡ 40 ↻ 8

Karim Sarhan @karim_at_desk · #t17

That review is the knot. You are asking for proof, and the brand has zero sales so far. The launch problem here is not the price — the price is sound. The problem is that there are no first 20 reviews building the bridge.

≡ 25 ↻ 4

H **Hassan El-Far** @hassan_el7asb · #t18

Let me say something useful instead of grumbling: a candle that burns properly lasts longer if you trim the wick every time before lighting. Most people do not, so they burn the wax down a tunnel. If you are a serious brand, teach people — it cuts your returns and buys goodwill.

≡ 35 ↻ 9

M **Maryam Abdelal** @maryam_gifts · #t19

An idea worth taking: if Nasma published scent profiles (who 'Bahary' suits, who 'El-Manshiya' suits) as content, those become choosing tools, not ads. If I need a gift for a sea person, I pick 'Bahary' because I understood it, not because the label was pretty.

≡ 31 ↻ 7

K **Karim Sarhan** @karim_at_desk · #t20

One small but important thing: 'the jar stays with you' — good, but nothing explains how to get the wax out at the end without scratching the glass. A 20-second video solves that too. This brand needs content, not a price fix.

≡ 30 ↻ 5

H **Hassan El-Far** @hassan_el7asb · #t21

Last word: other brands say the same words. Aromatica says 'handmade in Cairo', charges 320, posts real photos and a known wrap. You are telling the same story for 180. Until something proves the words, I want evidence.

≡ 38 ↻ 6

M **Maryam Abdelal** @maryam_gifts · #t22

Harsh but fair. I will pay the moment I see one real review — even from my groups. 600 followers is not proof; 6 reviews are the proof.

≡ 24 ↻ 3

K **Karim Sarhan** @karim_at_desk · #t23

To the brand: your price is sound (4.5-5.1 EGP/hour against IKEA's 5.5) — but there is no burn test, no summer-shipping protection, no scent samples, and no gift policy. Four near-zero-cost additions flip this post from curiosity to a purchase. It is not your price that is missing — it is the proof.

≡ 44 ↻ 10

H **Hassan El-Far** @hassan_el7asb · #t24

The post's own best line: 'production is limited'. Fine — but limited needs paperwork: a photo of a real workshop, a batch at work, one face. Right now it reads like a magic shop — half the price of Aromatica, half the visibility.

≡ 36 ⟳ 7

M **Maryam Abdelal** @maryam_gifts · #t25

Summary: a full gift at 210 is a rare offer — the cheapest handmade brand is at about 450. I shared the photo in the group and three friends already liked the idea. All that is missing: one real review and one real wrap photo — and I order today.

≡ 39 ⟳ 8

K **Karim Sarhan** @karim_at_desk · #t26

Today's summary for whoever is reading: Nasma is not overpriced — it is under-proven. 35-40 hours without a video, soy without paperwork, a wrap without photos, summer shipping without protection. Any one of those becomes real with one honest piece of content. On the other side: the Alexandria-neighborhood story is the sharpest edge in this market — nobody sells a district; they sell a brand.

≡ 47 ⟳ 12

What we could not verify

- Jumia Egypt timed out twice — no scented-candle prices from the biggest local marketplace.
- Amazon.eg returned 503 — unavailable for price research.
- No published burn-hour standard or test exists in the local market — every burn figure (IKEA, Aromatica, Nasma) is the seller's claim.
- No published customer reviews for any local artisan soy candle (Creative Egypt has zero) — social proof for the whole category is near zero.
- Nasma's production cost and margin are unknown — any price advice here is market math, not a viability verdict.
- No safety-certification information (wicks, thermal stability) for any local brand surfaced in the research.
- The souq-candle estimate (20-60 EGP) is the owner's word, not a published source — it needs a quick check by walking a full souq.
- The primary websearch tool was down (HTTP 402) for part of the run; research ran through DuckDuckGo HTML, so coverage may be thinner than a normal flow.

Sources

[s1] أروماتيكا — شموع معطرة في مصر مصنوعة يدوياً في القاهرة (Aromatica) High reliability
https://aromatica-eg.com/ar/collections/scented-candles/
Accessed: 2026-11-11 · The seller's own page with its own listed prices, dated 8 October 2026. Range 320-1250 EGP before shipping, shipping from 80 EGP, gift wrap 50 EGP.

[s2] ايكيا مصر — شموع معطرة (IKEA Egypt, 75 products) High reliability
https://www.ikea.com/eg/ar/cat/scented-candles-10783/
Accessed: 2026-11-11 · Official category page with visible prices and promo dates (discounts until 31.12.2026). The 20-hour cup showed at 169 discounted to 59, and the 40-hour cup at 219.

[s3] كرييتيف إيجيبت — شمع الصويا المعطر (Creative Egypt) High reliability
https://www.creativeegypt.org/product/شمع-الصويا-المعطر/
Accessed: 2026-11-11 · An Egyptian artisan marketplace: a soy scented candle at 410 EGP, out of stock, zero reviews.

[s4] كانبكام — شمع صويا ١٠٠٪ برائحة اللافندر (kanbkam / noon Egypt, brand: Tablowhaty) Medium reliability
https://www.kanbkam.com/eg/ar/lavender-scented-candle-100-soywax-candle-Z4D01E068B091945B5F8BZ
Accessed: 2026-11-11 · JSON-LD data from the page: 400 g of 100% soy wax, brand Tablowhaty, price 0 and OutOfStock — recorded as a category-exists signal, not as a price benchmark.

[s5] Nasma brief, sent by the owner High reliability
provided by user (brief)
Accessed: 2026-11-11 · Source for every stated product fact (180/480/+30 EGP, 220 g, 35-40 hours, delivery 25/45, capacity 60 candles/week, 600 followers) and for the owner's estimate of the popular souq-candle market (20-60 EGP), to be confirmed with a quick check.